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17+ Years | B2B SaaS | Frontend Architecture & Engineering Leadership | Jaipur, India

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01 | Frontend Engineering Highlights

- Architected a proprietary, extensible **pipeline step framework** at Harness using Abstract Factory design patterns during the 2020 full product rewrite — solving a critical QA bottleneck where any single step change triggered complete re-validation of all 65+ steps, each requiring 2 weeks of testing and recurring regression failures.
- Designed each pipeline step as a fully isolated, independently manageable unit — enabling zero cross-step impact on change or addition, zero performance regression, and **fewer than 10 bugs raised against the core framework** across its entire lifetime.
- Framework proved so robust that the **core has remained unchanged for 6+ years**, now supporting 500+ pipeline steps across Harness CD, CI, and Feature Flags — effectively becoming a proprietary internal standard at Harness.
- Drove unit test automation from **0% to 70% coverage** at Harness as Staff Software Engineer — coaching the team on TDD and establishing a culture of test discipline that underpinned the entire platform rewrite.

02 | Building Products from Scratch

- Led the complete ground-up rewrite of the **Harness platform UI in 2020** — architecting a new frontend designed to scale from a single CI/CD product to a unified multi-product platform spanning CD, CI, Feature Flags, and beyond.
- Designed and built the **core pipeline step framework, shared UI component library, custom router framework, and build system with quality controls** — the foundational architecture on which the entire Harness frontend still operates today.
- Engineered a **proprietary string externalization framework** for React using YAML, mustache.js templating, and TypeScript for full validation and autocomplete; enabling documentation teams to manage thousands of UI strings with zero developer intervention. Published on the Harness engineering blog.
- Built a **scalable tooltip framework** with 1,500+ tooltips managed independently by the documentation team via a unique DOM node identification system and CI-driven npm package.
- Delivered **100% performant pipeline UI** with zero performance regression across the rewrite, even as product surface expanded 4–5× in scope.

03 | Managing and Building Teams

- Served as **founding UI engineer in India** at both ServiceNow (Performance Analytics BU) and AppDynamics (Cisco) — building the frontend engineering function from zero in each organisation, scaling to **10+ developers within 9–12 months** in both cases.
- At Harness, joined as one of the first 7–8 UI engineers and grew into managing the **entire global UI engineering organisation within 18–20 months** — ultimately leading **30+ frontend developers across 5 countries** (Ireland, Serbia, US, Brazil, and Canada).
- Built a reputation for **re-recruiting proven talent** — consistently identifying and rehiring engineers from previous teams, reducing hiring risk and accelerating team ramp-up.
- Conducted **thousands of technical interviews** and developed a strong conviction that raw coding ability combined with learning agility is a stronger hiring signal than current framework knowledge.
- Established a **structured intern-to-engineer pipeline** — daily 30-minute coaching sessions with milestone and goal-based progression — converting **20+ interns at Harness** and a further **6+ at Goldcast** into production-ready engineers.

04 | Client & Customer Facing Experience

- Served as **engineering-side owner of all customer relationships** at Goldcast for 18+ months — acting as the senior technical escalation point across the entire customer base, bridging engineering accountability with customer success outcomes.
- Managed a critical escalation with one of the **world's top financial institutions** — when a platform issue during a live event forced the client to abandon Goldcast mid-event, personally de-escalated the situation and restored confidence with a clear recovery commitment.
- Conducted a **2-hour live technical session** with the client the following day — resolved 2–3 outstanding demands in real time, delivered immediate fixes, and personally assumed full account ownership without deflecting blame onto the team.
- Provided **6 months of dedicated personal oversight** — becoming the single point of engineering accountability, universally referred to within the company as *'Kapil's account.'*
- Outcome: the client **renewed at 2× their previous contract value** — a six-figure deal — driven entirely by trust rebuilt through hands-on technical leadership and consistent personal commitment.

05 | Working with Global Partners & Leadership

- During the 2020 Harness platform rewrite, conducted a **6-hour live coding session over Zoom with Jyoti Bansal (CEO & Co-founder, Harness)** and the UX Head — starting at 11 PM — to prototype the first visual direction of the new platform. This session directly shaped the UI architecture and design language the product was built upon.
- Operated seamlessly across **Ireland, Serbia, US, Brazil, and Canada** as engineering manager for Harness's global UI organisation — managing delivery, culture, and team development across significant time zone and cultural differences.
- At Goldcast, became **executive leadership's trusted partner for critical people retention** — identified as the person best placed to engage and retain high-value engineers at risk of leaving through direct, honest conversations about career growth and long-term vision.
- Demonstrated throughout career that **engineering credibility and personal trust are inseparable** — earning a level of access and confidence with CEOs, UX leadership, and global executives typically reserved for much larger organisational roles.

06 | Technology Innovations & Revenue / Scale / Users

- Contributed to **Harness achieving 8× ARR scale** during a 3.5-year tenure — joining as Principal/Staff Engineer and exiting as Senior Engineering Manager having helped architect the core platform supporting this growth.
- Part of the Goldcast leadership team that drove strong revenue growth, culminating in a **successful acquisition by Cvent** — one of the world's leading event technology platforms.
- Drove **annual cost savings of \$190K** by migrating observability tooling across 6+ products from an incumbent vendor to Coralogix — executing the transition at roughly one-quarter of the previous cost (\$60K vs \$250K annually).
- Delivered an additional **\$40K annual saving** by migrating feature flag management from LaunchDarkly to Harness Feature Flags — identifying the opportunity, owning the migration, and eliminating redundant vendor cost.
- Presented a **formal annual cost and revenue impact review** to leadership for 3 consecutive years — quantifying engineering's direct contribution to company P&L through software savings, retained revenue, and deal enablement.
- Became a **trusted technical closer for the sales organisation** — regularly engaged to unblock renewals and new acquisitions. Deals enabled include contracts with **two of the top AI companies currently operating in the market.**
- Personally accountable for **retaining multiple six-figure customer contracts** through hands-on engineering support and escalation management over an 18-month period.

- Currently managing and developing **3 engineering managers at Goldcast** — owning their growth, decision-making frameworks, and leadership effectiveness as direct reports within the engineering organisation.
- Successfully transitioned **2 Individual Contributors to Engineering Managers at Goldcast** — identifying leadership potential early, creating progressive ownership opportunities, and building team confidence in their authority. Both transitions were well received by their respective teams.
- At Harness, identified and invested in **Yunus AM**, a Senior IC, as a future engineering leader — providing structured 1-year coaching on people management and leadership presence. Yunus went on to become **UI Engineering Manager at SigNoz**, successfully leading a large frontend team.
- Established a consistent **personal philosophy around leadership development** — identifying slope over intercept, investing early in high-potential engineers regardless of current seniority, with a track record of people who outgrow their roles and go on to lead teams at scale.
- Recognised internally at Goldcast as the **go-to leader for people confidence and retention** — trusted by executive leadership to step into sensitive conversations with engineers at risk, demonstrating that coaching extends beyond formal reporting lines.